

Student Counselor

FF12 Education and training · ISCO-08 2359 · CBS 0115 Onderwijsbegeleiders, onderwijskundigen en overige docenten · seniority medior · Also known as: Student Mentor, Academic Counselor

Supports pupils individually on study progress, motivation and personal circumstances, alongside the subject teacher's role.

The student counselor follows a pupil on several fronts at once and signals when study progress or wellbeing comes under pressure. Unlike the subject teacher, who assesses one subject, this role looks beyond a single school subject. Selection often tests listening skill, while the ability to refer to heavier help in time without breaking the relationship of trust is rarely tested.

Key figures for this profile

25 skills · 5 competencies to measure · 6 knockout skills · centre of gravity: Professional knowledge domains 30%, Collaboration and interpersonal effectiveness 25%, Communication and influence 13%

1 Competencies to measure

These are the behavioural and ability constructs in this profile. Each one shows which hrmforce questionnaire measures it.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
empathy Competency (50-framework): Sensitiviteit Knockout	 N4	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Summarises the other person's feelings and interests before proposing a solution and checks whether that summary is correct.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
Stress tolerance Competency (50-framework): Stressbestendigheid	 N4	Big Fifty, 15PF, Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Keeps working in a structured way at peak load, keeps agreements with clients clear and flags early which results are at risk.
interpersonal sensitivity Competency (50-framework): Sensitiviteit	 N3	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback, Kleurenprofiel (Jung)	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.
Verbal reasoning	 N3	Ability Scan	Cognitieve capaciteitentest	Extracts the core arguments from a report of several pages and shows with textual references which conclusion does and does not follow.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
Professional demeanour and representation Competency (50-framework): Organisatiesensitiviteit		360 Feedback, Competency Check	Praktijkobservatie	Represents the team with clients and external parties, chooses appropriate language and addresses colleagues on inappropriate conduct.

2 Full skill profile

Every skill in this profile, sorted by weight. The behavioural anchor under each skill belongs to the target level.

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Pupil guidance Develops the school's guidance structure, draws up referral protocols and coaches mentors in their role.	■■■■■ N5	5	yes	Praktijkobservatie	Competency Check, Ontwikkelgesprek
V	Clear oral expression Builds an unprepared spoken explanation into core point, background and next step, and adapts pace to the listener.	■■■■■ N4	5	yes	Assessment center	Communicatiestijlen, Competency Check
V	Instructional practice Independently varies formats with a mixed ability group and adjusts the explanation on the basis of signals from the class.	■■■■■ N4	5	yes	Praktijkobservatie	Werkproef, Competency Check

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Pedagogical practice Recognises patterns in group behaviour, independently chooses an approach and discusses concerns about a pupil with the support coordinator.		5	yes	Praktijkobservatie	Competency Check, Werkproef
G	empathy Summarises the other person's feelings and interests before proposing a solution and checks whether that summary is correct.		4	yes	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback
G	Stress tolerance Keeps working in a structured way at peak load, keeps agreements with clients clear and flags early which results are at risk.		4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 15PF, Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
G	interpersonal sensitivity Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.	 N3	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback, Kleurenprofiel (Jung)
V	de-escalating and setting limits States which limit is being crossed when behaviour is unwanted, what the consequence is, and ends the conversation when needed.	 N3	4	no	Situational Judgement Test	Conflictstijlen, Big Fifty, Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)
V	Assessment and grading Independently constructs a test with a test matrix, checks the results for flaws and discusses grading standards with subject colleagues.	 N3	4	yes	Portfolio/bewijsstuk	Portfolio, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
A	Verbal reasoning Extracts the core arguments from a report of several pages and shows with textual references which conclusion does and does not follow.	 N3	3	no	Cognitieve capaciteitentest	Ability Scan
V	Critical thinking and source evaluation Detects fallacies and selective evidence in reports and states which conclusion the data do support.	 N3	3	no	Werkproef	Competency Check, Werkproef
V	Presenting Tailors structure, examples and level of detail to the knowledge of the audience and handles critical questions without preparation.	 N3	3	no	Assessment center	Competency Check, 360 Feedback

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Written expression Independently writes texts with opening, core and closing, chooses a tone per audience and applies fixed terms consistently.	 N3	3	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Competency Check
V	working in teams Divides work with colleagues, shares information others need without being asked, and adjusts own planning to fit team goals.	 N3	3	no	360 feedback	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback, Competency Check
V	social perspective taking Describes the other party's arguments in own words during a disagreement and tests which underlying assumptions differ.	 N3	3	no	Situational Judgement Test	Communicatiestijlen, 360 Feedback

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	conflict handling Brings parties together, separates positions from interests and records the resulting agreement and its follow-up in writing.	 N3	3	no	Assessment center	Conflictstijlen, Big Fifty, 360 Feedback
V	Planning and organising Plans the work of the team for several weeks, distributes tasks and reshuffles on disruptions without missing deadlines.	 N3	3	no	Werkproef	Competency Check, 360 Feedback, Werkproef
G	Professional demeanour and representation Represents the team with clients and external parties, chooses appropriate language and addresses colleagues on inappropriate conduct.	 N3	3	no	Praktijkobservatie	360 Feedback, Competency Check

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Reflecting on own practice Takes time to review difficult situations, looks for patterns in own conduct and records one improvement point in writing.	 N3	3	no	360 feedback	360 Feedback, Ontwikkelgesprek
V	Professional currency and specialist literature Tracks sources and guidelines structurally, weighs their quality and adapts the own working method to new insights.	 N3	3	no	Portfolio/bewijsstuk	Portfolio, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
V	Instructional design and curriculum Independently designs a teaching period with coherent goals, materials and assessment and aligns it with subject colleagues.	 N3	3	no	Portfolio/bewijsstuk	Portfolio, Competency Check

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Communication with parents and carers Independently holds a conversation with parents about disappointing results, states the facts and reaches joint agreements.	 N3	3	no	Praktijkobservatie	Werkproef, Competency Check
V	Working with digital devices and applications Selects the appropriate device and application for each task and fixes common disruptions without support from others.	 N3	2	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
K	AI literacy Explains in own words that a language model predicts from patterns and can therefore produce incorrect output.	 N2	2	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
T	Using collaboration platforms Shares files and messages in the designated channel and follows instructions on permissions and storage locations.	 N2	1	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, 360 Feedback

3 Levels per seniority

The same profile with the job family seniority adjustment applied. Target levels are clamped to 1 to 5.

Skill	junior	medior	senior
Pupil guidance	N5	N5	N5
Clear oral expression	N3	N4	N5
Instructional practice	N3	N4	N5
Pedagogical practice	N3	N4	N5
empathy	N3	N4	N5
Stress tolerance	N3	N4	N5
interpersonal sensitivity	N2	N3	N4
de-escalating and setting limits	N2	N3	N4
Assessment and grading	N2	N3	N4
Verbal reasoning	N2	N3	N4
Critical thinking and source evaluation	N2	N3	N4
Presenting	N2	N3	N4
Written expression	N2	N3	N4
working in teams	N2	N3	N4
social perspective taking	N2	N3	N4
conflict handling	N2	N3	N4
Planning and organising	N2	N3	N4
Professional demeanour and representation	N2	N3	N4
Reflecting on own practice	N2	N3	N4
Professional currency and specialist literature	N2	N3	N4
Instructional design and curriculum	N2	N3	N4
Communication with parents and carers	N2	N3	N4
Working with digital devices and applications	N2	N3	N4
AI literacy	N1	N2	N3
Using collaboration platforms	N1	N2	N3

4 The proficiency scale

Level	Label	Autonomy	Complexity	Scope	Depth of knowledge
N1	Guided	works under supervision and follows instruction	routine, one variable at a time	own task	basic understanding of terminology
N2	Applying	works independently within set frameworks	familiar situations with limited variation	own role	working knowledge, applies standard approach
N3	Proficient	sets own approach and seeks input proactively	several variables, some ambiguity	own team or process	thorough knowledge, weighs alternatives
N4	Advanced	directs others and decides on the approach	complex, with conflicting interests	several teams or a department	in-depth knowledge, advises others
N5	Leading	sets the standard and the policy	strategic, under high uncertainty	organisation, value chain or profession	authority, advances the profession

5 Behavioural anchors per skill

Anchors sit at N1, N3 and N5. N2 and N4 are deliberately not anchored: raters interpolate between them, following the O*NET convention.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Pupil guidance Guides pupils with learning difficulties, study choices and personal questions, refers on where needed and tracks progress in the file.	Conducts a guidance conversation under supervision using the standard form and records the agreements in the pupil file.	Independently analyses the cause of lagging results, makes a plan with the pupil and involves parents and the support team.	Develops the school's guidance structure, draws up referral protocols and coaches mentors in their role.
Clear oral expression Phrasing messages in spoken language so that the core point, the structure and the requested action are immediately clear to the listener.	Restates in own words what has been agreed and repeats the core of the instruction as a check.	Builds an unprepared spoken explanation into core point, background and next step, and adapts pace to the listener.	Sets the organisation wide standard for spoken clarity, explains complex strategic choices understandably and coaches others on their word choice.
Instructional practice Delivers lessons in which learning goals, explanation, assignments and feedback align, and attunes pace and format to the group.	Delivers a lesson segment under guidance according to a prepared lesson plan and keeps to the indicated formats.	Independently varies formats with a mixed ability group and adjusts the explanation on the basis of signals from the class.	Develops the school's instructional framework, grounds it in research and guides colleagues through lesson observation and feedback.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Pedagogical practice Creates a safe and orderly learning climate, guides pupil behaviour and attunes the approach to age and developmental stage.	Applies the class agreements under guidance and addresses pupils on unwanted behaviour following the standard routine.	Recognises patterns in group behaviour, independently chooses an approach and discusses concerns about a pupil with the support coordinator.	Develops the school's pedagogical policy, draws up behaviour protocols and guides teams through stalled group dynamics.
empathy Putting oneself in another person's situation and feelings, reflecting that back in own words and acting with regard for that situation.	Listens to another person without interrupting and asks how the situation feels for that person.	Summarises the other person's feelings and interests before proposing a solution and checks whether that summary is correct.	Builds room for the perspective of those affected into policy and processes and addresses managers on impersonal decision making.
Stress tolerance Keeps delivering work of the same quality under time pressure, opposition or unexpected turns and maintains a businesslike tone with others.	Keeps working on the current task as pressure rises and asks the supervisor which task can wait.	Keeps working in a structured way at peak load, keeps agreements with clients clear and flags early which results are at risk.	Keeps the organisation workable in crises, takes decisions under high uncertainty and sets the standard for composed action under pressure.
interpersonal sensitivity Noticing verbal and non-verbal signals from others, naming what stands out and adjusting own behaviour accordingly during the contact.	Notices when a conversation partner disengages or hesitates and asks whether the explanation is clear.	Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.	Trains others in recognising social signals and uses that insight when designing sensitive change processes across the organisation.
de-escalating and setting limits Reducing rising tension or unwanted behaviour by staying calm, stating the limit clearly and steering or ending the conversation.	Stays calm when facing an angry reaction, lets the other person speak and calls in a colleague or manager.	States which limit is being crossed when behaviour is unwanted, what the consequence is, and ends the conversation when needed.	Establishes organisation-wide agreements on transgressive behaviour, arranges support and follow-up, and holds managers to that line.
Assessment and grading Constructs tests and assessment tasks that cover the learning goals, grades work against criteria and gives pupils usable feedback.	Administers an existing test according to instruction and grades the work using the answer model provided.	Independently constructs a test with a test matrix, checks the results for flaws and discusses grading standards with subject colleagues.	Develops the institution's assessment policy, safeguards examination quality and advises examination boards on grading standards.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Verbal reasoning Understands written and spoken language and draws logical conclusions from it, also when the text is long, dense or ambiguous.	Summarises a short work instruction in own words and points out which word or sentence remains unclear.	Extracts the core arguments from a report of several pages and shows with textual references which conclusion does and does not follow.	Dissects legal or policy texts with conflicting passages, reformulates the central question and substantiates the chosen reading for the whole organisation.
Critical thinking and source evaluation Tests claims for logic, evidence and the interest of the source and thereby distinguishes facts from opinions and assumptions.	Asks what a claim is based on and checks whether the source is named and can be found.	Detects fallacies and selective evidence in reports and states which conclusion the data do support.	Sets the assessment criteria for sources and claims, including for texts made by artificial intelligence, and enforces them organisation wide.
Presenting Building and delivering a message to a group with a clear line of argument, fitting materials and attention to reactions and questions from the audience.	Presents a prepared set of slides about own work and answers factual questions with help from an experienced colleague.	Tailors structure, examples and level of detail to the knowledge of the audience and handles critical questions without preparation.	Presents at external conferences on behalf of the organisation, sets the key message for the field and coaches others on their delivery.
Written expression Putting thoughts into correct and readable text with a logical paragraph structure, fitting tone and word choice suited to the reader.	Writes short messages and reports free of language errors after using a checking tool and a review round by a colleague.	Independently writes texts with opening, core and closing, chooses a tone per audience and applies fixed terms consistently.	Draws up the writing guide and house style for the organisation, approves publications on content and develops the writing skill of teams.
working in teams Contributing to a team result by dividing tasks, sharing information, keeping agreements and involving colleagues in the work at hand.	Carries out an own task within the team as agreed and reports to the team lead when something does not work.	Divides work with colleagues, shares information others need without being asked, and adjusts own planning to fit team goals.	Designs collaboration agreements for several teams in the organisation, evaluates them against results and revises them on the basis of data.
social perspective taking Explicitly reconstructing another person's viewpoint, including interests and assumptions, and using it to adapt the conversation or one's own proposal.	Names on request which interest another person has in a topic and checks that with that person.	Describes the other party's arguments in own words during a disagreement and tests which underlying assumptions differ.	Develops methods with which teams routinely gather multiple perspectives on decisions and tests whether this improves decision quality.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
conflict handling Naming a difference of interest or opinion, clarifying the positions of those involved and reaching a workable agreement with them.	Reports a conflict to own manager and describes factually what happened and what was said.	Brings parties together, separates positions from interests and records the resulting agreement and its follow-up in writing.	Mediates conflicts with high stakes between departments or partners and establishes organisational policy for resolving conflict.
Planning and organising Placing activities, people and resources in time, setting priorities and arranging dependencies so that agreed results are delivered on schedule.	Makes a daily or weekly schedule for own tasks and sticks to the agreed order and times.	Plans the work of the team for several weeks, distributes tasks and reshuffles on disruptions without missing deadlines.	Sets the planning system for the organisation, links annual plan, capacity and budget and decides on conflicting claims.
Professional demeanour and representation Behaves in contact with clients, colleagues and external parties according to the organisation's conduct and dress standards, including outside the own workplace.	Follows house rules on conduct, language and dress and asks the supervisor for guidance when in doubt.	Represents the team with clients and external parties, chooses appropriate language and addresses colleagues on inappropriate conduct.	Represents the organisation in the public domain and sets the standards of conduct that apply when doing so.
Reflecting on own practice Looks back on own work in a structured way, names the effect of choices made and formulates one concrete point to do differently.	Answers the questions of the supervisor after a task about what went well and what was difficult.	Takes time to review difficult situations, looks for patterns in own conduct and records one improvement point in writing.	Builds reflection into work processes as a standard step, guides peer review across the organisation and keeps difficult assumptions open for discussion.
Professional currency and specialist literature Follows developments in the own profession through literature, guidelines and networks and works relevant new insights into own practice.	Reads the professional information received and names which part matters for the own work.	Tracks sources and guidelines structurally, weighs their quality and adapts the own working method to new insights.	Assesses the state of the field, weighs conflicting research and determines which guidelines the organisation will follow from now on.
Instructional design and curriculum Designs learning pathways and materials in which goals, content, formats and assessment cohere, aligned with attainment targets or qualification requirements.	Supplements an existing lesson plan under guidance with assignments that match the stated learning goal.	Independently designs a teaching period with coherent goals, materials and assessment and aligns it with subject colleagues.	Develops the curriculum for the entire programme, links it to statutory requirements and leads its introduction across all teams.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Communication with parents and carers Informs parents and carers about a pupil's development and behaviour, holds conversations when there are concerns and makes agreements with them.	Informs parents about practical matters as agreed and refers substantive questions to the mentor.	Independently holds a conversation with parents about disappointing results, states the facts and reaches joint agreements.	Sets the policy for communication with parents, mediates in complaints and trains colleagues in difficult parent conversations.
Working with digital devices and applications Uses computers, mobile devices and standard applications to carry out work tasks, adjusts settings and resolves simple usage problems without help.	Opens and uses the prescribed applications for own tasks and asks for help whenever an unfamiliar message appears.	Selects the appropriate device and application for each task and fixes common disruptions without support from others.	Defines organisation wide which digital workplace facilities are used and guides their introduction across all teams.
AI literacy Knows how AI systems work, what they can and cannot do, states where they fit or not and uses correct terminology.	Explains in own words that a language model predicts from patterns and can therefore produce incorrect output.	Judges per work task whether AI is suitable, names the main limitations and explains how it works to colleagues.	Defines what AI literacy means in the organisation, measures the level and links it to training and deployment policy.
Using collaboration platforms Collaborates in digital platforms by sharing files, setting up tasks and channels and following agreements on working together online.	Shares files and messages in the designated channel and follows instructions on permissions and storage locations.	Sets up channels, task boards and permissions for a team and addresses colleagues on agreements about online collaboration.	Determines organisational policy for digital collaboration and steers the introduction of new ways of working together.

6 Assessment methods and validity

The validities are the corrected meta-analytic estimates from Sackett, Zhang, Berry and Lievens (2022) in the Journal of Applied Psychology, which replace the older Schmidt and Hunter (1998) figures. The spread matters as much as the mean: with a high SD, validity varies strongly by context.

Assessment method	rho	SD	What it is
Praktijkobservatie	-	-	Structured workplace observation with a form based on behavioural anchors.
Assessment center	0.29	0.09	Multiple exercises, multiple assessors, dimension-wise scoring.
Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	0.40	0.15	Self-report of behavioural preferences. At hrmforce the Big Fifty and the 15PF.
Situational Judgement Test	0.12	0.11	Scenario with response options, scored on knowledge or behavioural tendency.
Portfolio/bewijsstuk	-	-	A collection of prior work or results, assessed against fixed criteria.
Cognitieve capaciteitentest	0.41	0.14	Standardised test of verbal, numerical or abstract reasoning.
Werkproef	0.33	0.09	The candidate performs a representative work sample under standardised conditions.
360 feedback	-	-	Multiple raters around the person rate behaviour against behavioural anchors.
Kennistoets	0.40	0.13	Test of declarative job knowledge, usually assembled per client.

7 Assessment instruments for this job

hrmforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Competency Check	12	Competentiebeoordeling op gedragsniveau
360 Feedback	10	Meervoudige beoordeling op gedragsankers
Werkproef	8	Representatief werkfragment onder gestandaardiseerde condities
Big Fifty	6	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst, 150 items, 25 factoren
Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)	4	Toets van vakkennis, per klant samengesteld
Portfolio	3	Beoordeling van eerder werk tegen vaste criteria
Ontwikkelgesprek	2	Gestructureerd ontwikkelgesprek

hrmforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Communicatiestijlen	2	Voorkeursstijl in communicatie
Mentale Weerbaarheid (4C)	2	Mentale weerbaarheid volgens het 4C-model
Conflictstijlen	2	Voorkeursstijl in conflictsituaties
15PF	1	Persoonlijkheidsprofiel, korter alternatief voor de Big Fifty
Kleurenprofiel (Jung)	1	Vier kleurentypen, gekoppeld aan Big Fifty-factoren
Ability Scan	1	Capaciteitentest: verbaal, numeriek en abstract redeneervermogen

8 How to use this profile

1. Agree the profile with the hiring manager before the first candidate is measured. Weights shifted afterwards make the outcome indefensible.
2. Choose the assessment method per skill from the Assessment method column. Combine at most three methods per candidate.
3. Calibrate the assessors in a two-hour session using the anchors in chapter 5. Anchors without rater training deliver little.
4. Fill in the match calculator and discuss the gaps in the development conversation. Type A and type G are selection criteria, not one-quarter development goals.

Source: hrmforce Skills Framework 2.0, version 2.0.0, built 2026-09-08. Crosswalks to ESCO v1.2.1, O*NET 31.0, Lightcast Open Skills, SFIA 9, DigComp 3.0, EntreComp, LifeComp, GreenComp, AILit, WEF Future of Jobs 2025, ISCO-08 and the Dutch CBS occupational classification BRC 2014 edition 2025. This profile is a starting point, not a standard: align it with your own organisation before selecting on it.